

Gender:

Further investigation is needed to explore the possible similarities and differences between the genders in terms of mobile entertainment usage patterns, particularly as these demographic details could be used by the European mobile entertainment industry to better adapt and target their products to end-user needs.

In terms of SMS, females are more likely to rate SMS as a more important service than males, whilst males are more likely to rate WAP as an important service. It remains questionable whether a simple extrapolation of such gender differences to provide indicators for EMS and MMS usage in the near future is wise.

The INFUSIO study indicated of the customers surveyed who played mobile games 56 per cent were male and 44 per cent female. This is a similar gender split to that of the PC/console games market.

Mobile Entertainment: SMS and MMS

It seems probable that full multimedia MMS is unlikely to take off in the youth market as a tool for everyday communication in the near future. However, it does seem possible that it will be popular for event-driven communication and marketing such as for birthdays, holidays and so forth.

Users tend to perceive SMS as cheaper and often more convenient than voice. However, the upgraded functionality of colour, audio and graphics may not entice users to shift to MMS for as long as the initial cost of MMS and related compliant devices remains high. For the majority of messages, multimedia is seen as adding little or no value for additional cost and complexity.

Mobile Entertainment: WAP and the 3G Challenge

The difficulties which faced the end-user with regards WAP - including dropped calls, slow response rates and low quality and choice of content—meant that services were largely deemed a fail-